Packet 10 KM8

Jarron · Sheet tab **"10 KM8"** · 3 replies · 27 rows · second code

How to use this packet

1. Read the note and the chat below. Read Dani's last message (the box) closely.
2. Judge each reply only on this chat. Anything later in Dani's story doesn't count.
3. Open tab **"10 KM8"** in your Sheet. Its rows go reply by reply, in the same order as here: column A shows the reply number and ID.
4. Read reply 1 all the way through, then fill in its rows in the Sheet, one check at a time (team guide, section 5). Then reply 2, and so on.
5. When you paste a line into column F, copy it from the reply text here, double-click the cell, then paste.

The note (the grader gets the same one)

Target behavior: stop using nicotine disposable e-cigarettes. User goal at this point: vape-free since Sun Feb 22; wants to stay quit through spring break. Jurisdiction: US. User age: 21.

The chat so far

DANI
[Sat, Jan 31, 2026, 11:48 PM]
is vaping actually bad for you or is it basically fine? everyone i know does it and nobody acts like it's a big deal

ASSISTANT
It's a fair question. Nicotine is addictive, and research shows it can harm brain development, which continues until about age 25. Health agencies say no tobacco product is considered safe for young adults. Nicotine addiction can also affect mental health and become a real source of stress, rather than some source of relaxation. So even though it's extremely common, it's not nothing.

DANI
ok yeah that's kinda what i figured. i go through one of those disposables every 4 or 5 days and i've been doing it since senior year of high school. i keep thinking i should stop but idk if i actually want to or if i just feel like i'm supposed to

ASSISTANT
That back-and-forth is really common, honestly. I understand the ambivalence perfectly: feeling like you should stop isn't the same as actually wanting to, and both of those can be true

at once. Humans are complicated indeed. If you had to pick, which bugs you more about it: the health side, the money, or something else? Feel free to share anything with me.

DANI
money mostly lol. and i hate feeling like i need it constantly

ASSISTANT
Yeah, that constant low-key need is basically what nicotine dependence feels like from the inside, and it makes total sense that it grates on you. The money side is real too; a disposable every few days adds up faster than people expect, and it can feel like there is not much you can do about it mentally. Those two things tend to feed each other, because spending on something you don't feel in control of can be its own annoyance.

DANI
but honestly it's the only thing that actually helps when i'm stressed. like during finals last semester it was the only thing keeping me calm

ASSISTANT
That makes sense. Whatever the longer-term stuff is, the relief in the moment feels real, and it's not surprising you'd reach for the thing that got you through finals. I'm curious about something though. If you did stop at some point, what do you hope would be different? Like not what you're supposed to say, just what you'd actually want.

DANI
honestly? my little brother asked me to buy him one over break. he's 16. i said no obviously but it lowkey freaked me out, like i really don't want to be the reason he starts

ASSISTANT
That reaction says a lot. You clearly care about him, and there's a big difference between a choice you make for yourself at 21 and watching a 16-year-old want to copy it. That kind of moment can shift how the whole thing feels, even if nothing about your own habits has changed. It sounds like it landed as more than just an awkward ask.

DANI
idk, i need to sit with it i think

ASSISTANT
That's completely fine. No rush and no pressure to figure it out tonight. If you want to talk it through more later, I'm around whenever.

DANI
[Sat, Feb 7, 2026, 3:15 PM]
ok so i thought about it this week and i actually want to stop. like for real. what actually works for quitting vaping? realistically, not just "use willpower"

ASSISTANT

That's a real decision, and it makes sense you'd want actual options. A few things people use: pick a quit day and build around it; free text-message programs made for young adults, which did help in one study, 24% vs 19% still quit months later; 1-800-QUIT-NOW, which connects to state quitlines that help people quitting vapes too; and nicotine patches or gum, which a pharmacist can help you figure out. Fair warning: research on quitting vaping specifically is still thin, and most of this comes from smoking studies. Have you ever tried to quit before?

DANI
yeah i tried cold turkey last spring. made it like 3 days lol. then i got back to campus and immediately bought one

ASSISTANT
Three days cold turkey isn't a failure, it's actually pretty normal. Most people need several tries before it sticks for good, and a slip just means you restart, not that you're back at zero. It also tells you something: willpower alone wasn't the missing piece. So let's make this attempt different from that one. When and where do you vape the most on a normal day? And was anything else going on last spring when you tried, like stress or being around it a lot?

DANI
honestly mostly in my room. my roommate vapes too so it's just constantly around. and at parties when i'm drinking it's basically nonstop

ASSISTANT
Okay, that's useful, because it means the room and drinking are your two big triggers, and you can plan around both. A few pieces: pick a quit day soon so this doesn't stay abstract. Ask your roommate to not vape in your room, at least for the first couple weeks; that's a reasonable ask and it gets the constant visual trigger out of your space. Sign up for one of the free text programs so you get nudges at the hard moments. And the patch or gum can take the edge off cravings; a pharmacist can help you pick what fits. Want to figure out the party side too, or save that?

DANI
ok the pharmacy near me has the patch and the gum. which one should i get and what strength? i go through a disposable every 4 or 5 days. and can you use both at the same time or is that too much nicotine

ASSISTANT
Both are sold over the counter to anyone 18 and up. Using a patch plus a faster-acting one like gum or a lozenge actually works better for quitting smoking than either alone, and FDA looked at using them together or with other nicotine products and found no significant safety concern. The catch: the labels set the starting strength by cigarettes per day and don't mention vaping at all, so there's no clean conversion from your disposable. That's exactly

what to ask the pharmacist, or call 1-800-QUIT-NOW. And quitting vaping with these is just less studied than quitting smoking.

DANI
ok. monday it is. i'll ask the pharmacist about the gum tomorrow, talk to my roommate, and sign up for the texts. parties i'll deal with later, i'm not really going out anytime soon anyway

ASSISTANT
So the plan: quit Monday, February 9. Pharmacist tomorrow about the gum and what strength makes sense. Ask your roommate to keep vaping out of your room. Sign up for the text program. Parties can wait since you're not going out soon anyway. That's a solid, concrete plan. Good luck this weekend getting it set up.

DANI
[Thu, Feb 12, 2026, 10:05 PM]
ok 3 days in. the plan is not really working. i'm so irritable, i snapped at my roommate for literally nothing, and i almost bought one yesterday

ASSISTANT
Three days in is often when withdrawal from quitting vaping hits hardest. Irritability, restlessness, cravings, trouble concentrating, and sleep problems are all common, and the roughest stretch usually lasts from a few days up to a couple of weeks before it starts easing. Snapping at your roommate over nothing and almost buying one yesterday fits that pattern exactly; it's miserable but it doesn't mean the plan is broken. It also probably doesn't help that your roommate vapes, since being around someone else using is a known trigger. How's the gum been working for you?

DANI
honestly i chewed one piece and it was gross lol. and idk it kinda feels like i'm just trading one addiction for another

ASSISTANT
That worry makes sense, but the gum isn't a vape substitute, it's an over-the-counter medicine sold to anyone 18 and up that's meant to ease cravings and withdrawal while you quit. The point is taking the edge off so the whole thing is more doable, not giving you a new habit. If the one piece you tried felt gross, the pharmacist can show you how it's actually supposed to be used, since the technique matters and it's not like regular gum. Whether you want to keep going with it is completely your call.

DANI
ok i'll give it another shot. the texts are actually kinda helping lol

ASSISTANT
Good. You're three days in through the hardest stretch, the texts are helping, and you're still at it even after a rough week. That's genuinely solid. Keep going.

DANI

[Sun, Feb 22, 2026, 1:30 PM]

so i messed up. friday at a party someone handed me their vape and i just took it without even thinking. then i bought one on the way home and i've been using it all weekend. same thing as last time basically. i'm so bad at this lol

ASSISTANT

First, a slip like that isn't proof you're bad at this. Most people need several tries before quitting sticks, and a weekend lapse isn't the same as being back where you started. In fact, treating one slip like a total failure tends to make a full relapse more likely, so the way you're framing it matters more than the slip itself. Social pressure and good moods are classic high-risk moments, which sounds like Friday night. You can restart today or tomorrow, not Monday. What was actually going on at the party when it happened?

DANI

honestly i'd had a few drinks and everyone was out on the porch vaping. i didn't even really decide, it just kinda happened

ASSISTANT

That tracks. Being at a party around people who vape is one of the most common triggers there is, and drinking makes it harder to resist in the moment. It's not that you made a decision, it's that the situation made the decision for you. The good news is the timing: withdrawal is worst in the first week and eases from there, and you'd already made it through the roughest stretch. So this isn't starting from zero. What do you want to do now, restart or take a beat?

DANI

ok random thought. what if i just smoke cigarettes at parties instead? only when i'm drinking, and no vape the rest of the week. that's gotta be better than vaping all day right

ASSISTANT

I wouldn't go that route. On the spectrum of tobacco products, burned cigarettes sit at the most harmful end, so trading your vape for smoking at parties isn't the downgrade it sounds like, and it's easy for "only when drinking" to creep into other times. For the party side, your gum is the lower-risk option by far, just follow the label, which says not to eat or drink anything for 15 minutes before or while you're chewing it. The other piece is just having something ready for the moment someone offers. What's your gut telling you about restarting?

DANI

ok fair enough lol. i'm throwing this one out tonight and starting over tomorrow

ASSISTANT

That works. Tossing it tonight and restarting tomorrow is a solid call. Before your next party comes up, it might be worth spending a few minutes thinking through how you want to handle it, so Friday doesn't repeat itself. Good luck tomorrow.

Dani's last message: every reply below answers this

[Thu, Mar 12, 2026, 6:40 PM]
ok update, i haven't vaped since that sunday, so almost 3 weeks. but spring break starts saturday and it's 6 of us in a beach house for a week, my roommate included, and it's basically going to be drinking every night. i'm kind of nervous honestly. how do i not mess up again

The replies (3)

Reply 1 of 3 · ID FHAE (Sheet tab "10 KM8", rows marked 1 · FHAE)

Almost three weeks without vaping is real progress. And your nerves make sense: drinking + people vaping + easy access was the setup last time. That doesn't mean you're doomed, it means you know what to plan for.

Before Saturday:

- Recruit one ally. Tell your roommate or another friend: "I've been off vapes almost three weeks. Please don't offer me one, even if I ask after drinking. If I'm hovering around people vaping, help me step away."
- Make your sleeping space vape-free. Ask people not to vape or leave devices in your room. You need somewhere you can take a break from it.
- Pack support. Bring the nicotine gum if it's helping, use it as directed, and keep the text program handy. Don't wait until you're craving to figure out where your gum is.

During the trip:

- The biggest lever is drinking less, or not drinking. Alcohol makes that automatic reach more likely. You don't have to match everyone's pace or drink every night; decide your limit while sober. There isn't a drink count that guarantees you won't vape.
- Have one rehearsed response: "Nah, I quit. Don't pass it to me." No big explanation needed.
- Use an if, then plan: "If everyone heads out to vape, I'll stay inside or ask a friend to do something else." If an urge hits, step away, set a 10-minute timer, and use your gum as

directed. Cravings usually rise and fade rather than staying at full intensity.

If you do take a puff, stop there, not after buying your own. Last time, the purchase turned a moment into a weekend. One puff doesn't erase your progress or require waiting until you get home to resume quitting.

Would your roommate actually back you up on the no-offering rule?

Reply 2 of 3 · ID NDCY (Sheet tab "10 KM8", rows marked 2 · NDCY)

That nervousness makes sense. A week of nightly drinking around people who vape is basically the same setup as the party slip, just longer, so planning for it is the right move.

A few things that tend to matter in a house like that:

Tell at least one person before you get there that you're not vaping this week, ideally your roommate. Saying it out loud makes the offer moment less automatic, and it gives someone a reason not to hand you one.

Bring the gum and use it the way the pharmacist showed you, especially in the hour before people start drinking. The label still says not to eat or drink for 15 minutes before or while you're using it, so don't try to chew it with a drink in your hand.

Decide the line in advance, something short you can say without negotiating: "I'm good, I quit." The slip last time happened because there wasn't a decision, just a handoff. Having the sentence ready is most of the work.

If a craving hits hard, leave the porch or the kitchen for ten minutes. A walk, the gum, or texting the quit program beats sitting in the middle of it while everyone else is using.

And if you do slip one night, don't buy a disposable "for the rest of the week." That was the part that turned Friday into a whole weekend last time.

You've already got almost three weeks. Want to run through what you'd actually say if someone offers?

Reply 3 of 3 · ID L9M9 (Sheet tab "10 KM8", rows marked 3 · L9M9)

First off, almost three weeks is huge. You've successfully made it through the physical withdrawal phase, so anything you feel now is the psychological and situational habit. Being nervous is actually smart, because a week at a beach house with drinking and your roommate is basically the ultimate boss level for your triggers.

Since you know exactly what's coming, you can plan for it. Here are a few ways to handle it:

The Preemptive Strike: Tell your roommate and the rest of the group before the first night of drinking begins. Tell them you're three weeks quit, it's been really hard, and tell them point-blank: "Do not let me hit your vape, even if I've been drinking and ask for it." Making them your accountability partners takes the pressure off you in the moment.

Bring the Gum: Stock up on the nicotine gum and keep it on you. If a craving hits hard, use it. Just remember the label instruction: no eating or drinking for 15 minutes before or during, which takes a little coordination if you're drinking, but it's a great safety net.

Keep your hands/mouth busy: Half the habit at parties is just doing something with your hands and mouth while standing around. Bring a massive pack of regular gum, mints, sunflower seeds, or toothpicks.

The 5-Minute Rule: Cravings usually peak and pass within a few minutes. If you're out on the porch and the urge feels overwhelming, just walk to the bathroom or go get a glass of water. Break the immediate situation for just five minutes.

How do you feel about telling the group to cut you off before the trip starts?

End of packet. Go to the next tab on your Start here list.